

Bhagavad Gita - Chapter 2

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

002. Chapter 2 Verses 1-10

VERSE 2.1

सञ्जय उवाच ।
तं तथा कृपयाविष्टमश्रुपूर्णाकुलेक्षणम् ।
विषीदन्तमिदं वाक्यमुवाच मधुसूदनः ॥ १ ॥

sañjaya uvāca |
taṁ tathā kṛpayāviṣṭam
aśrupūrṇākulekṣaṇam |
viṣīdantamidaṁ vākyaṁ
uvāca madhusūdanaḥ ||

- ◆ **sañjayaḥ uvāca** – Sanjaya said;
- ◆ **taṁ** – to him (Arjuna); **tathā** – thus; **kṛpayā-āviṣṭam** – overwhelmed with pity;
- ◆ **aśru-pūrṇa-ākula-īkṣaṇam** – whose eyes were full of tears and distressed;
- ◆ **viṣīdantam** – sorrowing; **idaṁ** – these; **vākyaṁ** – words;
- ◆ **uvāca** – spoke; **madhusūdanaḥ** – Madhusudana (Krishna).

In this manner, when Arjuna was plunged in a state of despondency, with eyes blurred with tears, Lord Krishna addressed these words to him.

VERSE 2.2

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
कुतस्त्वा कश्मलमिदं विषमे समुपस्थितम् ।
अनार्यजुष्टमस्वर्ग्यमकीर्तिकरमर्जुन ॥ २ ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |
kutastvā kaśmalamidam
viṣame samupasthitam |
anāryajuṣṭamasvargyam
akīrtikaramarjuna ||

- ◆ **śrī-bhagavān uvāca** – The Blessed Lord said;
- ◆ **kutaḥ** – whence; **tvā** – to you; **kaśmalam** – dejection/faint-heartedness; **idam** – this;
- ◆ **viṣame** – in this hour of peril; **samupasthitam** – come;
- ◆ **anārya-juṣṭam** – unbecoming of an Arya (noble person); **asvargyam** – leading not to heaven;
- ◆ **akīrti-karam** – causing disgrace; **arjuna** – O Arjuna.

The Lord said: O Arjuna! Whence, in this critical situation, has this mental dejection takes hold of you, shameful and Heaven-excluding?

VERSE 2.3

क्लैब्यं मा स्म गमः पार्थ नैतत्त्वय्युपपद्यते ।
क्षुद्रं हृदयदौर्बल्यं त्यक्त्वोत्तिष्ठ परन्तप ॥३॥

klaibyaṃ mā sma gamaḥ pārtha
naitattvayyupapadyate |
kṣudraṃ hṛdayadaurbalyaṃ
tyaktvottiṣṭha parantapa ||

- ◆ **klaibyam** – unmanliness/impotence; **mā sma gamaḥ** – do not yield to; **pārtha** – O Partha;
- ◆ **na** – not; **etat** – this; **tvayi** – in you; **upapadyate** – is fitting;
- ◆ **kṣudram** – petty; **hṛdaya-daurbalyam** – weakness of heart;
- ◆ **tyaktvā** – abandoning; **uttiṣṭha** – arise; **parantapa** – O scorcher of foes.

**O Arjuna! Do not yield to impotence. It does not befit you.
Cast off this wretched weakness of heart. Arise, O scorcher of
enemies!**

VERSE 2.4

अर्जुन उवाच ।

कथं भीष्ममहं सङ्ख्ये द्रोणं च मधुसूदन ।

इषुभिः प्रतियोत्स्यामि पूजार्हावरिसूदन ॥ ४ ॥

arjuna uvāca |

katham bhīṣmamahaṁ saṅkhye

droṇaṁ ca madhusūdana |

iṣubhiḥ pratiyotsyāmi

pūjārḥavarisūdana ||

◆ **arjunaḥ uvāca** – Arjuna said;

◆ **katham** – how; **bhīṣmam** – Bhishma; **aham** – I; **saṅkhye** – in battle;

◆ **droṇaṁ** – Drona; **ca** – and; **madhusūdana** – O Madhusudana;

◆ **iṣubhiḥ** – with arrows; **pratiyotsyāmi** – shall fight against;

◆ **pūjā-arḥau** – worthy of worship; **ari-sūdana** – O destroyer of enemies.

Arjuna Said: O Krishna! Bhishma and Drona are my teachers fit to be worshipped. How can I attack them with arrows in the battle?

VERSE 2.5

गुरुनहत्वा हि महानुभावान्
श्रेयो भोक्तुं भैक्ष्यमपीह लोके ।
हत्वार्थकामांस्तु गुरुनिहैव
भुञ्जीय भोगान् रुधिरप्रदिग्धान् ॥५॥

gurūnahatvā hi mahānubhāvān
śreyo bhoktum bhaikṣyamapīha loke |
hatvārthakāmāṃstu gurūnihaiva
bhuñjīya bhogān rudhirapradigdhān ||

- ◆ **gurūn** – elders/teachers; **ahatvā** – not killing; **hi** – indeed; **mahā-anubhāvān** – most noble;
- ◆ **śreyaḥ** – better; **bhoktum** – to eat; **bhaikṣyam** – food obtained by begging; **api** – even; **iha loke** – in this world;
- ◆ **hatvā** – killing; **artha-kāmān** – desiring wealth and gain; **tu** – but; **gurūn** – teachers; **iha** – here; **eva** – only;
- ◆ **bhuñjīya** – I would enjoy; **bhogān** – enjoyments; **rudhira-pradigdhān** – stained with blood.

It would be better, indeed, to live on alms in this world rather than to slay these high-souled teachers. But if I kill them, even here I shall enjoy wealth and desires stained with their blood.

VERSE 2.6

न चैतद्विद्मः कतरन्नो गरीयो
यद्वा जयेम यदि वा नो जयेयुः ।
यानेव हत्वा न जिजीविषाम
स्तेऽवस्थिताः प्रमुखे धार्तराष्ट्राः ॥ ६ ॥

na caitadvidmaḥ kataranno garīyo
yadvā jayema yadi vā no jayeyuḥ |
yāneva hatvā na jijīviṣāmas
te'vasthitāḥ pramukhe dhārtarāṣṭrāḥ ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **ca** – and; **etat** – this; **vidmaḥ** – we know; **katarat** – which; **naḥ** – for us; **garīyaḥ** – better;
- ◆ **yat vā** – whether; **jayema** – we should conquer; **yadi vā** – or if; **naḥ** – us; **jayeyuḥ** – they should conquer;
- ◆ **yān** – whom; **eva** – even; **hatvā** – having killed; **na** – not; **jijīviṣāmaḥ** – we wish to live;
- ◆ **te** – they; **avasthitāḥ** – are standing; **pramukhe** – in front; **dhārtarāṣṭrāḥ** – the sons of Dhritarashtra.

We do not know which would be the better for us: that we should conquer them or they should conquer us. Arrayed against us stand the very sons of Dhritarāshtra, after slaying whom we should not wish to live.

VERSE 2.7

कार्पण्यदोषोपहतस्वभावः
पृच्छामि त्वां धर्मसम्मूढचेताः ।
यच्छ्रेयः स्यान्निश्चितं ब्रूहि तन्मे
शिष्यस्तेऽहं शाधि मां त्वां प्रपन्नम् ॥७॥

kārpaṇyadoṣopahatasvabhāvaḥ
pṛcchāmi tvāṁ dharmasammūḍhacetash |
yacchreyaḥ syānniścitaṁ brūhi tanme
śiṣyaste'haṁ śādhi mām tvāṁ prapannam ||

- ◆ **kārpaṇya-doṣa** – the taint of pity/weakness; **upahata** – overcome; **svabhāvaḥ** – nature;
- ◆ **pṛcchāmi** – I ask; **tvām** – You; **dharma-sammūḍha-cetāḥ** – with a mind confused about duty;
- ◆ **yat** – what; **śreyaḥ** – the highest good; **syāt** – may be; **niścitaṁ** – decisively; **brūhi** – tell; **tat** – that; **me** – to me;
- ◆ **śiṣyaḥ** – disciple; **te** – Your; **aham** – I am; **śādhi** – instruct; **mām** – me; **tvām** – in You; **prapannam** – surrendered.

(O Krishna!) My mind is distracted by the taint of pity and I am ignorant of what my duty is, and so, I ask you to teach me what is good for me. I am your disciple. I take refuge in you.

VERSE 2.8

न हि प्रपश्यामि ममापनुद्याद्
यच्छोकमुच्छोषणमिन्द्रियाणाम् ।
अवाप्य भूमावसपत्नमृद्धं
राज्यं सुराणामपि चाधिपत्यम् ॥८॥

na hi prapaśyāmi mamāpanudyād
yaccho kamucchoṣaṇamindriyāṇām |
avāpya bhūmāvasapatnamṛddham
rājyaṁ surāṇāmapī cādhipatyam ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **hi** – indeed; **prapaśyāmi** – I see; **mama** – my; **apanudyāt** – would dispel;
- ◆ **yat** – which; **śokam** – grief; **ucchoṣaṇam** – drying up; **indriyāṇām** – the senses;
- ◆ **avāpya** – having obtained; **bhūmau** – on earth; **asapatnam** – unrivaled; **ṛddham** – prosperous;
- ◆ **rājyam** – kingdom; **surāṇām** – of the gods; **api** – even; **ca** – and; **ādhipatyam** – lordship.

I can find no means to drive away this grief which is drying up my senses. I will not be able to dispel it even if I win a prosperous, unrivaled kingdom on earth with sovereignty like the demigods in heaven.

VERSE 2.9

सञ्जय उवाच ।

एवमुक्त्वा हृषीकेशं गुडाकेशः परन्तप ।

न योत्स्य इति गोविन्दमुक्त्वा तूष्णीं बभूव ह ॥९॥

sañjaya uvāca |

evamuktvā hr̥ṣīkeśam

guḍākeśaḥ parantapa |

na yotsya iti govindam

uktvā tūṣṇīm babhūva ha ||

◆ **sañjayaḥ uvāca** – Sanjaya said;

◆ **evam** – thus; **uktvā** – having spoken; **hr̥ṣīkeśam** – to Hrishikesha (Krishna);

◆ **guḍākeśaḥ** – Gudakesha (Arjuna); **parantapa** – the scorcher of foes;

◆ **na yotsye** – I will not fight; **iti** – thus; **govindam** – to Govinda;

◆ **uktvā** – having said; **tūṣṇīm** – silent; **babhūva** – became; **ha** – indeed.

Sanjaya Said: Having spoke thus, Arjuna, the destroyer of foes, finally said to Lord Krishna, “I will not fight” and became silent.

VERSE 2.10

तमुवाच हृषीकेशः प्रहसन्निव भारत ।
सेनयोरुभयोर्मध्ये विषीदन्तमिदं वचः ॥ 10 ॥

tamuvāca hr̥ṣīkeśaḥ
prahasanniva bhārata |
senayorubhayormadhye
viṣīdantamidaṃ vacaḥ ||

- ◆ **tam** – to him; **uvāca** – spoke; **hr̥ṣīkeśaḥ** – Hrishiksha;
- ◆ **prahasan** – smiling; **iva** – as if; **bhārata** – O Bharata (Dhritarashtra);
- ◆ **senayoḥ ubhayoḥ madhye** – in the midst of the two armies;
- ◆ **viṣīdantam** – to the sorrowing one; **idam** – these; **vacaḥ** – words.

O king Dhritarashtra! Seeing Arjuna lamenting in the middle of two armies, Lord Krishna, as if laughing loud, spoke these words.

003. Chapter 2 Verses 11-12

VERSE 2.11

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
अशोच्यानन्वशोचस्त्वं प्रज्ञावादांश्च भाषसे ।
गतासूनगतासूंश्च नानुशोचन्ति पण्डिताः ॥ 11 ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |
aśocyānanvaśocastvaṃ
prajñāvādāṃśca bhāṣase |
gatāsūnagatāsūṃśca
nānuśocanti paṇḍitāḥ ||

- ◆ **śrī-bhagavān uvāca** – The Blessed Lord said;
- ◆ **aśocyān** – those not to be grieved for; **anvaśocaḥ** – have grieved; **tvam** – you;
- ◆ **prajñā-vādān** – words of wisdom; **ca** – and; **bhāṣase** – you speak;
- ◆ **gata-asūn** – the dead (those whose breath has gone); **agata-asūn** – the living (those whose breath has not gone); **ca** – and;
- ◆ **na** – not; **anuśocanti** – grieve; **paṇḍitāḥ** – the wise.

The Lord said: O Arjuna! You grieve for those for whom there need be no sorrow, yet you speak words of wisdom. The wise do not grieve for the dead or living.

VERSE 2.12

न त्वेवाहं जातु नासं न त्वं नेमे जनाधिपा ।
न चैव न भविष्यामः सर्वे वयमतः परम् ॥ 12 ॥

na tvevāhaṃ jātu nāsaṃ
na tvam neme janādhīpāḥ |
na caiva na bhaviṣyāmaḥ
sarve vayamataḥ param ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **tu** – but; **eva** – certainly; **aham** – I; **jātu** – at any time; **na** – not; **āsam** – existed;
- ◆ **na** – not; **tvam** – you; **na** – not; **ime** – these; **janādhīpāḥ** – kings;
- ◆ **na** – not; **ca** – and; **eva** – certainly; **na** – not; **bhaviṣyāmaḥ** – shall exist;
- ◆ **sarve** – all; **vayam** – we; **ataḥ param** – hereafter.

Never was there a time when I did not exist, nor you, nor these kings of men. Never will there be a time hereafter when any of us shall cease to be.

004. Chapter 2 Verses 13-15

VERSE 2.13

देहिनोऽस्मिन्यथा देहे कौमारं यौवनं जरा ।
तथा देहान्तरप्राप्तिर्धीरस्तत्र न मुह्यति ॥ 13 ॥

dehino'sminyathā dehe
kaumāraṃ yauvanaṃ jarā |
tathā dehāntaraprāptir
dhīrastatra na muhyati ||

- ◆ **dehinaḥ** – of the embodied soul; **asmin** – in this; **yathā** – as; **dehe** – body;
- ◆ **kaumāram** – childhood; **yauvanam** – youth; **jarā** – old age;
- ◆ **tathā** – so; **deha-antara-prāptiḥ** – attainment of another body;
- ◆ **dhīraḥ** – the wise; **tatra** – thereat; **na** – not; **muhyati** – is deluded.

Just as the man in this body passes through the various stages of boyhood, youth, and old age, like so, he passes into another body after death. The wise know it and are not deluded.

VERSE 2.14

मात्रास्पर्शास्तु कौन्तेय शीतोष्णसुखदुःखदाः ।
आगमापायिनोऽनित्यास्तांस्तितिक्षस्व भारत ॥ 14 ॥

mātrāsparśāstu kaunteya
śītoṣṇasukhaduḥkhadāḥ |
āgamāpāyino'nityās
tāmṣtitikṣasva bhārata ||

- ◆ **mātrā-sparśāḥ** – contacts of the senses with their objects; **tu** – but; **kaunteya** – O son of Kunti;
- ◆ **śīta-uṣṇa** – cold and heat; **sukha-duḥkha-dāḥ** – givers of pleasure and pain;
- ◆ **āgama-apāyinaḥ** – appearing and disappearing; **anityāḥ** – impermanent;
- ◆ **tān** – them; **titikṣasva** – endure; **bhārata** – O Bharata.

Contact of the senses with the objects produces heat and cold, pain and pleasure. These experiences come and go, and are impermanent. Endure them, O Arjuna!

VERSE 2.15

यं हि न व्यथयन्त्येते पुरुषं पुरुषर्षभ ।
समदुःखसुखं धीरं सोऽमृतत्वाय कल्पते ॥ 15 ॥

yam hi na vyathayantye
puruṣaṁ puruṣarṣabha |
samaduḥkhasukhaṁ dhīraṁ
so'mṛtattvāya kalpate ||

- ◆ **yam** – whom; **hi** – indeed; **na** – not; **vyathayanti** – afflict; **ete** – these;
- ◆ **puruṣam** – man; **puruṣa-ṛṣabha** – O chief among men;
- ◆ **sama-duḥkha-sukham** – equal in pain and pleasure; **dhīram** – wise;
- ◆ **saḥ** – he; **amṛtatvāya** – for immortality; **kalpate** – is fit.

**The firm man who is not affected by pain and pleasure, who
remains equal-minded, surely is fit for immortality, O
Arjuna, Chief of mortals!**

005. Chapter 2 Verse 16

VERSE 2.16

नासतो विद्यते भावो नाभावो विद्यते सतः ।
उभयोरपि दृष्टो ऽन्तस्त्वनयोस्तत्त्वदर्शिभिः ॥ 16 ॥

nāsato vidyate bhāvo
nābhāvo vidyate sataḥ |
ubhayorapi dr̥ṣṭo'ntas
tvanayostattvadarśibhiḥ ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **asataḥ** – of the unreal; **vidyate** – exists; **bhāvaḥ** – being;
- ◆ **na** – not; **abhāvaḥ** – non-existence; **vidyate** – exists; **sataḥ** – of the real;
- ◆ **ubhayoḥ** – of both; **api** – also; **dr̥ṣṭaḥ** – seen; **antaḥ** – the truth/conclusion;
- ◆ **tu** – but; **anayoḥ** – of these; **tattva-darśibhiḥ** – by the seers of Truth.

The unreal has no being, the real has no non-being. The final truth of these two has been seen indeed by those who have experienced the essence of things.

006. Chapter 2 Verses 17-18

VERSE 2.17

अविनाशि तु तद्विद्धि येन सर्वमिदं ततम् ।
विनाशमव्ययस्यास्य न कश्चित्कर्तुमर्हति ॥ 17 ॥

avināśi tu tadviddhi
yena sarvamidam tatam |
vināśamavyayasyāsyā
na kaścitkartumarhati ||

- ◆ **avināśi** – imperishable; **tu** – indeed; **tat** – that; **viddhi** – know;
- ◆ **yena** – by which; **sarvam idam** – all this; **tatam** – pervaded;
- ◆ **vināśam** – destruction; **avyayasya** – of the immutable; **asya** – of this;
- ◆ **na kaścit** – no one; **kartum arhati** – is able to do.

(O Arjuna!) Know that Atma by which the whole universe is pervaded is indestructible. No one can cause the destruction of the imperishable.

VERSE 2.18

अन्तवन्त इमे देहा नित्यस्योक्ताः शरीरिणः ।
अनाशिनोऽप्रमेयस्य तस्माद्युध्यस्व भारत ॥ 18 ॥

antavanta ime dehā
nityasyoktāḥ śarīriṇaḥ |
anāśino'prameyasya
tasmādyudhyasva bhārata ||

- ◆ **antavantaḥ** – having an end; **ime** – these; **dehāḥ** – bodies;
- ◆ **nityasya** – of the eternal; **uktāḥ** – are said; **śarīriṇaḥ** – of the embodied soul;
- ◆ **anāśinaḥ** – of the indestructible; **aprameyasya** – of the immeasurable;
- ◆ **tasmāt** – therefore; **yudhyasva** – fight; **bhārata** – O Bharata.

**These bodies which belong to the real imperishable,
unknowable Atma are said to be subject to an end; therefore
fight, O Arjuna!**

007. Chapter 2 Verse 19

VERSE 2.19

य एनं वेत्ति हन्तारं यश्चैनं मन्यते हतम् ।
उभौ तौ न विजानीतो नायं हन्ति न हन्यते ॥ 19 ॥

ya enaṃ vetti hantāraṃ
yaścainaṃ manyate hatam |
ubhau tau na vijānīto
nāyaṃ hanti na hanyate ||

- ◆ **yaḥ** – he who; **enam** – this (Soul); **vetti** – thinks; **hantāram** – slayer;
- ◆ ◆ **yaḥ** – he who; **ca** – and; **enam** – this; **manyate** – thinks; **hatam** – slain;
- ubhau** – both; **tau** – they; **na vijānītaḥ** – do not know;
- ◆ **na** – not; **ayam** – this; **hanti** – slays; **na hanyate** – is not slain.

He who thinks that Atma slays, or he who thinks that Atma is Slain, both these do not know the Truth. Atma does not slay, nor is slain.

008. Chapter 2 Verse 20-22

VERSE 2.20

न जायते म्रियते वा कदाचि
नायं भूत्वा भविता वा न भूयः ।
अजो नित्यः शाश्वतोऽयं पुराणो
न हन्यते हन्यमाने शरीरे ॥ 20 ॥

na jāyate mriyate vā kadācin-
nāyaṃ bhūtvā bhavitā vā na bhūyaḥ |
ajo nityaḥ śāśvato'yaṃ purāṇo
na hanyate hanyamāne śarīre ||

- ◆ **na** - never; **jāyate** - is born; **mriyate** - dies; **vā** - or; **kadācit** - at any time;
- ◆ **na** - not; **ayam** - this; **bhūtvā** - having been; **bhavitā** - will be; **vā** - or; **na** - not; **bhūyaḥ** - again;
- ◆ **ajah** - unborn; **nityaḥ** - eternal; **śāśvataḥ** - changeless; **ayam** - this; **purāṇaḥ** - ancient;
- ◆ **na** - not; **hanyate** - is killed; **hanyamāne** - being killed; **śarīre** - in the body.

Atma is not born, nor does it ever die; after having been it does not cease to be, unborn, eternal, changeless and ancient, it is not killed when the body is destroyed.

VERSE 2.21

DEVAGIAवेदाविनाशिनं नित्यं य एनमजमव्ययम् ।
कथं स पुरुषः पार्थ कं घातयति हन्ति कम् ॥ 21 ॥

vedāvināśinaṃ nityaṃ
ya enamajamavyayam |
kathaṃ sa puruṣaḥ pārtha
kaṃ ghātayati hanti kaṃ ||

- ◆ **veda** - knows; **avināśinaṃ** - indestructible; **nityaṃ** - eternal;
- ◆ **yaḥ** - who; **enam** - this; **ajam** - unborn; **avyayam** - immutable;
- ◆ **kathaṃ** - how; **saḥ** - that; **puruṣaḥ** - person; **pārtha** - O Partha (Arjuna);
- ◆ **kaṃ** - whom; **ghātayati** - causes to be killed; **hanti** - kills; **kaṃ** - whom.

O Arjuna! He who knows that Atma is birthless, deathless, real, and imperishable, whom can he slay or cause to be slain?

VERSE 2.22

वासांसि जीर्णानि यथा विहाय
नवानि गृह्णाति नरोऽपराणि ।
तथा शरीराणि विहाय जीर्णा
न्यन्यानि संयाति नवानि देही ॥ 22 ॥

vāsāṃsi jīrṇāni yathā vihāya
navāni grhṇāti naro'parāṇi |
tathā śarīrāṇi vihāya jīrṇāny
anyāni saṃyāti navāni dehī ||

- ◆ vāsāṃsi - clothes; jīrṇāni - worn out; yathā - as; vihāya - casting off;
- ◆ navāni - new; grhṇāti - takes on; narah - a man; aparāṇi - others;
- ◆ tathā - so; śarīrāṇi - bodies; vihāya - casting off; jīrṇāni - worn out;
- ◆ anyāni - others; saṃyāti - enters; navāni - new; dehī - the embodied Soul.

Just as a man casts off his worn-out clothes and puts on new ones so also the Self throws away its worn-out bodies and takes other fresh bodies.

009. Chapter 2 Verse 23-25

VERSE 2.23

नैनं छिन्दन्ति शस्त्राणि नैनं दहति पावकः ।
न चैनं क्लेदयन्त्यापो न शोषयति मारुतः ॥ 23 ॥

nainaṃ chindanti śastrāṇi
nainaṃ dahati pāvakaḥ |
na cainaṃ kledayantyāpo
na śoṣayati mārutaḥ ||

- ◆ **na** - not; **enam** - this; **chindanti** - cut; **śastrāṇi** - weapons;
- ◆ **na** - not; **enam** - this; **dahati** - burns; **pāvakaḥ** - fire;
- ◆ **na** - not; **ca** - and; **enam** - this; **kledayanti** - wet; **āpaḥ** - waters;
- ◆ **na** - not; **śoṣayati** - dries; **mārutaḥ** - wind.

**Weapons cannot cut, fire cannot burn, water cannot wet,
wind cannot dry up this Atma.**

अच्छेद्योऽयमदाह्योऽयमक्लेद्योऽशोष्य एव च ।
नित्यः सर्वगतः स्थाणुरचलोऽयं सनातनः ॥ 24 ॥

acchedyo'yamadāhyo'yam
akledyo'śoṣya eva ca |
nityaḥ sarvagataḥ sthāṇur
acalo'yam sanātanaḥ ||

- ◆ **acchedyaḥ** - cannot be cut; **ayam** - this; **adāhyaḥ** - cannot be burned; **ayam** - this;
- ◆ **akledyaḥ** - cannot be wetted; **aśoṣyaḥ** - cannot be dried; **eva** - indeed; **ca** - and;
- ◆ **nityaḥ** - eternal; **sarvagataḥ** - all-pervading; **sthāṇuḥ** - stable;
- ◆ **acalaḥ** - immovable; **ayam** - this; **sanātanaḥ** - ancient/timeless.

The Atma cannot be cut, cannot be burnt, cannot be wetted, and also cannot be dried up. It is eternal, all-pervading, firm, immovable, and ancient.

VERSE 2.25

अव्यक्तोऽयमचिन्त्योऽयमविकार्योऽयमुच्यते ।
तस्मादेवं विदित्वैनं नानुशोचितुमर्हसि ॥ 25 ॥

avyakto'yamacintyo'yam
avikāryo'yamucyate |
tasmādevaṃ viditvainaṃ
nānuśocitumarhasi ||

- ◆ **avyaktaḥ** - unmanifest; **ayam** - this; **acintyaḥ** - unthinkable; **ayam** - this;
- ◆ **avikāryaḥ** - unchangeable; **ayam** - this; **ucyate** - is said;
- ◆ **tasmāt** - therefore; **evam** - thus; **viditvā** - knowing; **enam** - this;
- ◆ **na** - not; **anuśocitum** - to grieve; **arhasi** - you should.

This self is unknowable by the senses, unthinkable by the mind, and is not subject to any kind of change. Knowing this, you should not grieve.

010. Chapter 2 Verse 26-27

VERSE 2.26

अथ चैनं नित्यजातं नित्यं वा मन्यसे मृतम् ।
तथापि त्वं महाबाहो नैवं शोचितुमर्हसि ॥ 26 ॥

atha cainaṃ nityajātaṃ
nityaṃ vā manyase mṛtaṃ |
tathāpi tvam mahābāho
naivaṃ śocitumarhasi ||

- ◆ **atha** - if however; **ca** - and; **enam** - this;
- ◆ **nityajātam** - constantly born; **nityam** - constantly; **vā** - or; **manyase** - you think; **mṛtam** - dead;
- ◆ **tathāpi** - even then; **tvam** - you; **mahābāho** - O mighty-armed;
- ◆ **na** - not; **evam** - so; **śocitum** - to grieve; **arhasi** - should.

O mighty-armed Arjuna! Even if you think that Self is constantly born and dies, you should not grieve in this way.

जातस्य हि ध्रुवो मृत्युर्ध्रुवं जन्म मृतस्य च ।
तस्मादपरिहार्येऽर्थे न त्वं शोचितुमर्हसि ॥ 27 ॥

jātasya hi dhruvo mṛtyur
dhruvaṃ janma mṛtasya ca |
tasmādaparihārye'rthe
na tvam śocitumarhasi ||

◆ **jātasya** - of the born; **hi** - for;

◆ **dhruvaḥ** - certain; **mṛtyuḥ** - death; **dhruvam** - certain; **janma** - birth;
mṛtasya - of the dead; **ca** - and;

◆ **tasmāt** - therefore; **aparihārye** - in the inevitable; **arthe** - matter;

◆ **na** - not; **tvam** - you; **śocitum** - to grieve; **arhasi** - should.

For to that which is born, death is certain, and to that which is dead, birth is certain. Therefore you should not grieve over the unavoidable.

011. Chapter 2 Verses 28-29

VERSE 2.28

अव्यक्तादीनि भूतानि व्यक्तमध्यानि भारत ।
अव्यक्तनिधनान्येव तत्र का परिदेवना ॥ 28 ॥

avyaktādīni bhūtāni
vyaktamadhyāni bhārata |
avyaktanidhanānyeva
tatra kā paridevanā ||

- ◆ **avyaktādīni** - unmanifest in the beginning; **bhūtāni** - beings;
- ◆ **vyaktamadhyāni** - manifest in the middle; **bhārata** - O Bharata;
- ◆ **avyaktanidhanāni** - unmanifest in death; **eva** - only;
- ◆ **tatra** - there; **kā** - what; **paridevanā** - lamentation.

All beings are unmanifest in their beginning, O Bhārata, manifest in their middle state, and unmanifest again in their end. Why, then, lament for them?

VERSE 2.29

आश्चर्यवत्पश्यति कश्चिदेन
माश्चर्यवद्वदति तथैव चान्यः ।
आश्चर्यवच्चैनमन्यः शृणोति
श्रुत्वाप्येनं वेद न चैव कश्चित् ॥ 29 ॥

āścaryavatpaśyati kaścidenam-
āścaryavadvadati tathaiva cānyaḥ |
āścaryavaccainamanyaḥ śṛṇoti
śrutvāpyenam veda na caiva kaścit ||

- ◆ āścaryavat - as a wonder; paśyati - sees; kaścit - someone; enam - this;
- ◆ āścaryavat - as a wonder; vadati - speaks; tathā - so; eva - indeed; ca - and; anyah - another;
- ◆ āścaryavat - as a wonder; ca - and; enam - this; anyah - another; śṛṇoti - hear;
- ◆ śrutvā - having heard; api - even; enam - this; veda - knows; na - not; ca - and; eva - indeed; kaścit - anyone.

Some look on the Self as a wonder; some speak of It as a wonder; some hear of It as a wonder; still others, though hearing, do not understand It at all.

012. Chapter 2 Verses 30-31

VERSE 2.30

देही नित्यमवध्योऽयं देहे सर्वस्य भारत ।
तस्मात्सर्वाणि भूतानि न त्वं शोचितुमर्हसि ॥ 30 ॥

dehī nityamavadhyo'yaṃ
dehe sarvasya bhārata |
tasmātsarvāṇi bhūtāni
na tvam śocitumarhasi ||

- ◆ **dehī** - the dweller in the body; **nityam** - always; **avadhyaḥ** - cannot be slain; **ayaṃ** - this;
- ◆ **dehe** - in the body; **sarvasya** - of all; **bhārata** - O Bharata;
- ◆ **tasmāt** - therefore; **sarvāṇi** - for all; **bhūtāni** - beings;
- ◆ **na** - not; **tvam** - you; **śocitum** - to grieve; **arhasi** - should.

O Arjuna! The Self existing in the body of all beings is never slain. So it is not right for you to grieve for any creature.

VERSE 2.31

स्वधर्ममपि चावेक्ष्य न विकम्पितुमर्हसि ।
धर्म्याद्धि युद्धाच्छ्रेयोऽन्यत्क्षत्रियस्य न विद्यते ॥ 31 ॥

svadharmamapi cāvekṣya
na vikampitumarhasi |
dharmyāddhi yuddhācchreyo'nyat
kṣatriyasya na vidyate ||

- ◆ **svadharmam** - own duty; **api** - also; **ca** - and; **avekṣya** - considering;
- ◆ **na** - not; **vikampitum** - to waver; **arhasi** - you should;
- ◆ **dharmyāt** - than righteous; **hi** - indeed; **yuddhāt** - than war; **śreyaḥ** - better; **anyat** - other;
- ◆ **kṣatriyasya** - for a kshatriya; **na** - not; **vidyate** - exists.

And moreover, considering your own duty, you should not waver, for, there is nothing higher for a Kshatriya than a righteous war.

013. Chapter 2 Verses 32-38

VERSE 2.32

यदृच्छया चोपपन्नं स्वर्गद्वारमपावृतम् ।
सुखिनः क्षत्रियाः पार्थ लभन्ते युद्धमीदृशम् ॥ 32 ॥

yadṛcchayā copapannam
svargadvāramapāvṛtam |
sukhinaḥ kṣatriyāḥ pārtha
labhante yuddhamīdṛśam ||

- ◆ yadṛcchayā - of its own accord; ca - and; upapannam - come/arrived;
- ◆ svarga-dvāram - door to heaven; apāvṛtam - wide open;
- ◆ sukhinaḥ - happy; kṣatriyāḥ - warriors; pārtha - O Partha;
- ◆ labhante - gain; yuddham - war; īdṛśam - such.

**Happy indeed are the kshatriyas, O Pārtha, to whom comes
such a war, offering itself unsought, opening the gate to
heaven.**

VERSE 2.33

अथ चेतत्त्वमिमं धर्म्यं संग्रामं न करिष्यसि ।
ततः स्वधर्मं कीर्तिं च हित्वा पापमवाप्स्यसि ॥ ३३ ॥

atha cettvamimam dharmyam
saṅgrāmam na kariṣyasi |
tataḥ svadharmam kīrtim ca
hitvā pāpamavāpsyasi ||

- ◆ **atha** - but; **cet** - if; **tvam** - you; **imam** - this; **dharmyam** - righteous;
- ◆ **saṅgrāmam** - battle; **na** - not; **kariṣyasi** - will perform;
- ◆ **tataḥ** - then; **svadharmam** - own duty; **kīrtim** - fame; **ca** - and;
- ◆ **hitvā** - losing; **pāpam** - sin; **avāpsyasi** - will incur.

But if you do not fight this righteous war you would incur sin by abandoning your own duty, name, and fame.

अकीर्तिं चापि भूतानि
कथयिष्यन्ति तेऽव्ययाम् ।
सम्भावितस्य चाकीर्ति
मरणदतिरिच्यते ॥ 34 ॥

akīrtiṃ cāpi bhūtāni
kathayiṣyanti te'vyayām |
sambhāvitasya cākīrtir
maraṇādatiricyate ||

- ◆ **akīrtim** - infamy; **ca** - and; **api** - also; **bhūtāni** - people;
- ◆ **kathayiṣyanti** - will speak; **te** - of you; **avyayām** - long-standing/perpetual;
- ◆ **sambhāvitasya** - for an honorable man; **ca** - and; **akīrtiḥ** - infamy;
- ◆ **maraṇāt** - than death; **atiricyate** - is worse.

And also, these people will speak of your everlasting dishonor, and to one who is honored, dishonor is worse than death.

भयाद्रणादुपरतं मंस्यन्ते त्वां महारथाः ।
येषां च त्वं बहुमतो भूत्वा यास्यसि लाघवम् ॥ 35 ॥

bhayādraṇāduparataṃ
maṃsyante tvāṃ mahārathāḥ |
yeṣāṃ ca tvam bahumato
bhūtvā yāsyasi lāghavam ||

- ◆ **bhayāt** - out of fear; **raṇāt** - from battle; **uparatam** - withdrawn;
- ◆ **maṃsyante** - will think; **tvām** - you; **mahārathāḥ** - great chariot-warriors;
- ◆ **yeṣām** - of whom; **ca** - and; **tvam** - you; **bahumataḥ** - highly esteemed;
- ◆ **bhūtvā** - having been; **yāsyasi** - will go to; **lāghavam** - insignificance/lightness.

Moreover, those great warriors from whom you received honor formerly would think that you turned away from battle out of fear, and regard you with little respect hereafter.

VERSE 2.36

अवाच्यवादांश्च बहून्वदिष्यन्ति तवाहिताः ।
निन्दन्तस्तव सामर्थ्यं ततो दुःखतरं नु किम् ॥ 36 ॥

avācyavādāṃśca bahūn
vadiṣyanti tavāhitāḥ |
nindantastava sāmāthyam
tato duḥkhataram nu kim ||

- ◆ **avācyavādān** - unspeakable words; **ca** - and; **bahūn** - many;
- ◆ **vadiṣyanti** - will say; **tava** - your; **ahitāḥ** - enemies;
- ◆ **nindantaḥ** - slandering; **tava** - your; **sāmāthyam** - prowess;
- ◆ **tataḥ** - than that; **duḥkhataram** - more painful; **nu** - indeed; **kim** - what.

Your enemies belittle your ability, and in various ways speak words of ill-fame and shame about you. What is there more painful than this?

VERSE 2.37

हतो वा प्राप्स्यसि स्वर्गं जित्वा वा भोक्ष्यसे महीम् ।
तस्मादुत्तिष्ठ कौन्तेय युद्धाय कृतनिश्चयः ॥ ३७ ॥

hato vā prāpsyasi svargam
jītvā vā bhokṣyase mahīm |
tasmāduत्तिष्ठ kaunteya
yuddhāya kṛtaniścayaḥ ||

- ◆ **hataḥ** - slain; **vā** - or; **prāpsyasi** - you will gain; **svargam** - heaven;
- ◆ **jītvā** - conquering; **vā** - or; **bhokṣyase** - you will enjoy; **mahīm** - the earth;
- ◆ **tasmāt** - therefore; **uttiṣṭha** - arise; **kaunteya** - O son of Kunti;
- ◆ ◆ **yuddhāya** - for battle; **kṛtaniścayaḥ** - determined.

If you are killed in the battle, you will go to heaven; if you win, you will enjoy the earth. Therefore arise, O son of Kunti, resolved to fight.

VERSE 2.38

सुखदुःखे समे कृत्वा लाभालाभौ जयाजयौ ।
ततो युद्धाय युज्यस्व नैवं पापमवाप्स्यसि ॥३८॥

sukhaduḥkhe same kṛtvā
lābhālābhau jayājayau |
tato yuddhāya yujyasva
naivam pāpamavāpsyasi ||

- ◆ **sukha-duḥkhe** - in pleasure and pain; **same** - equal/alike; **kṛtvā** - making;
- ◆ **lābha-alābhau** - in gain and loss; **jaya-ajayau** - in victory and defeat;
- ◆ **tataḥ** - then; **yuddhāya** - for battle; **yujyasva** - engage;
- ◆ **na** - not; **evam** - thus; **pāpam** - sin; **avāpsyasi** - you will incur.

**Having an equal mind in pain and pleasure, gain and loss,
victory and defeat, engage in battle and thereby you will not
incur sin.**

014. Chapter 2 Verses 39-40

VERSE 2.39

एषा तेऽभिहिता साङ्ख्ये
बुद्धिर्योगे त्विमां शृणु ।
बुद्ध्या युक्तो यया पार्थ
कर्मबन्धं प्रहास्यसि ॥ 39 ॥

eṣā te'bhīhitā sāṅkhye
buddhiryoge tvimāṃ śṛṇu |
buddhyā yukto yayā pārtha
karmabandham prahāsyasi ||

- ◆ eṣā – this; te – to you; abhīhitā – declared; sāṅkhye – in (the path of) Knowledge;
- ◆ buddhiḥ – wisdom; yoge – in (the path of) Action; tu – but; imāṃ – this; śṛṇu – hear;
- ◆ buddhyā – with wisdom; yuktaḥ – endowed; yayā – by which; pārtha – O Partha;
- ◆ karma-bandham – the bondage of action; prahāsyasi – you shall cast off.

O Arjuna! So far the knowledge of Sankhya Yoga about Atma is declared. Now hear the knowledge of Karma Yoga, knowing which you shall cast off the bondage of work.

VERSE 2.40

नेहाभिक्रमनाशोऽस्ति प्रत्यवायो न विद्यते ।
स्वल्पमप्यस्य धर्मस्य त्रायते महतो भयात् ॥ 40 ॥

nehābhikramanāśo'sti
pratyavāyo na vidyate |
svalpamapyasya dharmasya
trāyate mahato bhayāt ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **iha** – in this; **abhikrama-nāśaḥ** – loss of effort; **asti** – is;
- ◆ **pratyavāyaḥ** – contrary result/sin; **na** – not; **vidyate** – exists;
- ◆ **svalpam** – very little; **api** – even; **asya** – of this; **dharmasya** – discipline/practice;
- ◆ **trāyate** – protects/saves; **mahataḥ** – from great; **bhayāt** – fear.

In this, no effort is ever lost and no harm is ever done. Even very little of this dharma saves a man from the Great Fear.

015. Chapter 2 Verses 41-44

VERSE 2.41

व्यवसायात्मिका बुद्धिरेकेह कुरुनन्दन ।
बहुशाखा ह्यनन्ताश्च बुद्धयोऽव्यवसायिनाम् ॥ 41 ॥

vyavasāyātmikā buddhir
ekeha kurunandana |
bahuśākhā hyanantāśca
buddhayo'vyavasāyinām ||

- ◆ **vyavasāyātmikā** – resolute; **buddhiḥ** – intellect;
- ◆ **ekā** – one/single; **iha** – here; **kuru-nandana** – O joy of the Kurus;
- ◆ **bahu-śākhāḥ** – many-branched; **hi** – indeed; **anantāḥ** – endless; **ca** – and;
- ◆ **buddhayaḥ** – thoughts/intellects; **avyavasāyinām** – of the irresolute.

O Arjuna! There is only one faith and thought for those who practice this Karma Yoga. The minds of others are divided into various branches, and their thoughts and speculations are endless.

O Arjuna! The unwise utter flowery speech, taking pleasure in the laudatory words of the Vedas, and say that there is nothing else but pleasures and enjoyments either here or in Heaven.

VERSE 2.43

कामात्मानः स्वर्गपरा जन्मकर्मफलप्रदाम् ।
क्रियाविशेषबहुलां भोगैश्वर्यगतिं प्रति ॥४३॥

kāmātmānaḥ svargaparā
janmakarmaphalapradām |
kriyāviśeṣabahulām
bhogaiśvaryagatiṃ prati ||

- ◆ **kāmātmānaḥ** – full of desires; **svarga-parāḥ** – regarding heaven as the highest goal;
- ◆ **janma-karma-phala-pradām** – leading to (new) birth as the reward of actions;
- ◆ **kriyā-viśeṣa-bahulām** – full of specific rituals;
- ◆ **bhoga-aiśvarya-gatiṃ** – attainment of enjoyment and power; **prati** – towards.

They are full of desire, with heaven as their highest goal, leading to new births as the effect of their own Karma, and they engage themselves in a multiplicity of specific works for the purpose of acquiring enjoyments and prosperity.

VERSE 2.44

भोगैश्वर्यप्रसक्तानां तयापहृतचेतसाम् ।
व्यवसायात्मिका बुद्धिः समाधौ न विधीयते ॥ 44 ॥

bhogaiśvaryaprasaktānām
tayāpahṛtacetasām |
vyavasāyātmikā buddhiḥ
samādhau na vidhīyate ||

- ◆ **bhoga-aiśvarya-prasaktānām** – of those attached to pleasure and power;
- ◆ **tayā** – by that (flowery speech); **apahr̥ta-cetasām** – whose minds are drawn away;
- ◆ **vyavasāyātmikā** – resolute; **buddhiḥ** – intellect;
- ◆ **samādhau** – in the mind (or in meditation); **na** – not; **vidhīyate** – is formed.

The mind of such men who are drawn away by attachment to pleasure and wealth, cannot be concentrated to remain fixed in the ecstasy of divine contemplation.

016. Chapter 2 Verses 45-47

VERSE 2.45

त्रैगुण्यविषया वेदा निस्त्रैगुण्यो भवार्जुन ।
निर्द्वन्द्वो नित्यसत्त्वस्थो निर्योगक्षेम आत्मवान् ॥ 45 ॥

traiguṇyaviṣayā vedā
nistraiguṇyo bhavārjuna |
nirdvandvo nityasattvastho
niryogakṣema ātmavān ||

- ◆ **traiguṇya-viṣayāḥ** – dealing with the three Gunas; **vedāḥ** – the Vedas;
- ◆ **nistraiguṇyaḥ** – free from the three Gunas; **bhava** – be; **arjuna** – O Arjuna;
- ◆ **nirdvandvaḥ** – free from dualities; **nitya-sattva-sthaḥ** – established in eternal Truth (Sattva);
- ◆ **nir-yoga-kṣemaḥ** – free from (the thought of) acquisition and preservation; **ātmavān** – self-possessed.

The first part of the Vedas (Karma Kanda) deal with material things pertaining to the three Gunas. One should transcend the three Gunas, become free from the operation of the pairs of opposites, take refuge in the pure sattvic state, and firmly establish himself in Atma.

VERSE 2.46

यावानर्थ उदपाने सर्वतः सम्प्लुतोदके ।
तावान्सर्वेषु वेदेषु ब्राह्मणस्य विजानतः ॥ 46 ॥

yāvānārtha udapāne
sarvataḥ samplutodake |
tāvānsarveṣu vedeṣu
brāhmaṇasya vijānataḥ ||

- ◆ **yāvān** – as much; **arthaḥ** – use; **uda-pāne** – in a small reservoir of water;
- ◆ **sarvataḥ** – everywhere; **sampluta-udake** – being flooded with water;
- ◆ **tāvān** – so much; **sarveṣu** – in all; **vedeṣu** – in the Vedas;
- ◆ **brāhmaṇasya** – for a Brahmana; **vijānataḥ** – who knows (the Truth).

To an enlightened person who has known the Self, all the Vedas are of as much use as is a reservoir of water in a place where there is a flood.

VERSE 2.47

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन ।
मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि ॥ 47 ॥

karmaṇyevādhikāraṣte
mā phaleṣu kadācana |
mā karmaphalāheturbhūr
mā te saṅgo'stvakarmaṇi ||

- ◆ **karmaṇi** – in action; **eva** – only; **adhikāraḥ** – right; **te** – your;
- ◆ **mā** – never; **phaleṣu** – in fruits; **kadācana** – at any time;
- ◆ **mā** – not; **karma-phala-hetuḥ** – cause of the fruit of action; **bhūḥ** – be;
- ◆ **mā** – not; **te** – your; **saṅgaḥ** – attachment; **astu** – let there be; **akarmaṇi** – in inaction.

You have the right to work only, and not to the fruits of work. Let not the fruit of action be your motive, nor let your attachment be to inaction.

017. Chapter 2 Verses 47

VERSE 2.47

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन ।
मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि ॥ 47 ॥

karmaṇyevādhikāraṣte
mā phaleṣu kadācana |
mā karmaphalāheturbhūr
mā te saṅgo'stvakarmaṇi ||

- ◆ **karmaṇi** – in action; **eva** – only; **adhikāraḥ** – right; **te** – your;
- ◆ **mā** – never; **phaleṣu** – in fruits; **kadācana** – at any time;
- ◆ **mā** – not; **karma-phala-hetuḥ** – cause of the fruit of action; **bhūḥ** – be;
- ◆ **mā** – not; **te** – your; **saṅgaḥ** – attachment; **astu** – let there be; **akarmaṇi** – in inaction.

You have the right to work only, and not to the fruits of work. Let not the fruit of action be your motive, nor let your attachment be to inaction.

018. Chapter 2 Verses 48-51

VERSE 2.48

योगस्थः कुरु कर्माणि सङ्गं त्यक्त्वा धनञ्जय ।
सिद्धयसिद्धयोः समो भूत्वा समत्वं योग उच्यते ॥ 48 ॥

yogasthaḥ kuru karmāṇi
saṅgaṃ tyaktvā dhanañjaya |
siddhyasiddhyoḥ samo bhūtvā
samatvaṃ yoga ucyate ||

- ◆ **yogasthaḥ** – established in Yoga; **kuru** – perform; **karmāṇi** – actions;
- ◆ **saṅgam** – attachment; **tyaktvā** – abandoning; **dhanañjaya** – O Dhananjaya (Arjuna);
- ◆ **siddhi-asiddhyoḥ** – in success and failure; **samaḥ** – even-minded; **bhūtvā** – becoming;
- ◆ **samatvam** – equanimity; **yogaḥ** – Yoga; **ucyate** – is called.

O Arjuna! Steadfast in Yoga, giving up all attachment, unmindful of success or failure, do your work. Such equanimity of mind is called Yoga.

VERSE 2.49

दूरेण ह्यवरं कर्म बुद्धियोगाद्धनञ्जय ।
बुद्धौ शरणमन्विच्छ कृपणाः फलहेतवः ॥ 49 ॥

dūreṇa hyavaram karma
buddhiyogāddhanañjaya |
buddhau śaraṇamanviccha
kṛpaṇāḥ phalahetavaḥ ||

- ◆ **dūreṇa** – by far; **hi** – indeed; **avaram** – inferior; **karma** – action;
- ◆ **buddhi-yogāt** – than the Yoga of wisdom; **dhanañjaya** – O Dhananjaya;
- ◆ **buddhau** – in wisdom; **śaraṇam** – refuge; **anviccha** – seek;
- ◆ **kṛpaṇāḥ** – wretched/pitiful; **phala-hetavaḥ** – those motivated by fruits.

O Arjuna! Work with attachment is far inferior to nishkama karma. Therefore seek refuge in desireless action with equanimity of mind. Those who work for fruits and rewards are wrecked.

VERSE 2.50

बुद्धियुक्तो जहातीह उभे सुकृतदुष्कृते ।
तस्माद्योगाय युज्यस्व योगः कर्मसु कौशलम् ॥ 50 ॥

buddhiyukto jahātiha
ubhe sukr̥taduṣkr̥te |
tasmādyogāya yujyasva
yogaḥ karmasu kauśalam ||

- ◆ **buddhi-yuktaḥ** – endowed with wisdom; **jahāti** – casts off; **iha** – in this life;
- ◆ **ubhe** – both; **sukr̥ta-duṣkr̥te** – good and evil deeds;
- ◆ **tasmāt** – therefore; **yogāya** – to Yoga; **yujyasva** – devote yourself;
- ◆ **yogaḥ** – Yoga; **karmasu** – in actions; **kauśalam** – skill.

The man of equanimity born of wisdom releases himself both from good and bad even in this life. Therefore strive for nishkama karma with an equal mind. Yoga is skill in action.

VERSE 2.51

कर्मजं बुद्धियुक्ता हि फलं त्यक्त्वा मनीषिणः ।
जन्मबन्धविनिर्मुक्ताः पदं गच्छन्त्यनामयम् ॥ 51 ॥

karmajaṃ buddhiyuktā hi
phalaṃ tyaktvā manīṣiṇaḥ |
janmabandhavinirmuktāḥ
padaṃ gacchantyanāmayam ||

- ◆ **karma-jam** – born of action; **buddhi-yuktāḥ** – endowed with wisdom; **hi** – indeed;
- ◆ **phalam** – fruit; **tyaktvā** – abandoning; **manīṣiṇaḥ** – the wise;
- ◆ **janma-bandha-vinirmuktāḥ** – freed from the bondage of birth;
- ◆ **padam** – state; **gacchanti** – attain; **anāmayam** – beyond pain/blissful.

Wise men endowed with equanimity, having abandoned the fruits of action, go to the abode beyond all sorrow and evil.

019. Chapter 2 Verses 52-54

VERSE 2.52

यदा ते मोहकलिलं बुद्धिर्व्यतितरिष्यति ।
तदा गन्तासि निर्वेदं श्रोतव्यस्य श्रुतस्य च ॥ 52 ॥

yadā te mohakalilam
buddhirvyatitarīṣyati |
tadā gantāsi nirvedam
śrotavyasya śrutasya ca ||

- ◆ **yadā** – when; **te** – your; **moha-kalilam** – mire of delusion;
- ◆ **buddhiḥ** – intellect; **vyatitarīṣyati** – shall cross;
- ◆ **tadā** – then; **gantāsi** – you shall attain; **nirvedam** – indifference;
- ◆ **śrotavyasya** – of what is to be heard; **śrutasya** – of what has been heard; **ca** – and.

When your mind has crossed the mire of delusion, you will achieve indifference regarding things already heard and things yet to be heard.

VERSE 2.53

श्रुतिविप्रतिपन्ना ते यदा स्थास्यति निश्चला ।
समाधावचला बुद्धिस्तदा योगमवाप्स्यसि ॥ 53 ॥

śrutivipratipannā te
yadā sthāsyati niścalā |
samādhāvacalā buddhis
tadā yogamavāpsyasi ||

- ◆ **śruti-vipratipannā** – perplexed by hearing (conflicting doctrines); **te** – your;
- ◆ **yadā** – when; **sthāsyati** – shall stand; **niścalā** – immovable;
- ◆ **samādhau** – in the Self (or in concentration); **acalā** – steady;
- ◆ **buddhiḥ** – intellect; **tadā** – then; **yogam** – Yoga; **avāpsyasi** – you shall attain.

When your intellect which is perplexed by hearing the various sastras becomes steady and immovable in ecstatic concentration, then you shall attain union with the Supreme Being.

अर्जुन उवाच ।

स्थितप्रज्ञस्य का भाषा समाधिस्थस्य केशव ।

स्थितधीः किं प्रभाषेत किमासीत ब्रजेत किम् ॥ 54 ॥

arjuna uvāca |

sthitaprajñasya kā bhāṣā

samādhisthasya keśava |

sthitadhīḥ kiṁ prabhāṣeta

kimāsīta vrajeta kim ||

◆ **arjunaḥ uvāca** – Arjuna said;

◆ **sthitaprajñasya** – of one whose wisdom is steady; **kā** – what; **bhāṣā** – description;

◆ **samādhisthasya** – of one who is established in Samadhi; **keśava** – O Kesava;

◆ **sthitadhīḥ** – the person of steady wisdom; **kim** – how; **prabhāṣeta** – speaks;

◆ **kim** – how; **āsīta** – sits; **vrajeta** – walks; **kim** – how.

Arjuna said: O Krishna! What are the characteristics of a man of steady wisdom? How does the man merged in the super-conscious state, sit and move?

020. Chapter 2 Verses 55-56

VERSE 2.55

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

प्रजहाति यदा कामान्सर्वान्पार्थ मनोगतान् ।

आत्मन्येवात्मना तुष्टः स्थितप्रज्ञस्तदोच्यते ॥ 55 ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |

prajahāti yadā kāmān

sarvānpārtha manogatān |

ātmanyevātmanā tuṣṭaḥ

sthitaprajñastadocyate ||

◆ śrī-bhagavān uvāca – The Blessed Lord said;

◆ prajahāti – casts off; yadā – when; kāmān – desires;

◆ sarvān – all; pārtha – O Partha; manogatān – of the mind;

◆ ātmani – in the Self; eva – only; ātmanā – by the Self; tuṣṭaḥ – satisfied;

◆ sthitaprajñah – of steady wisdom; tadā – then; ucyate – is called.

The Blessed Lord said: When a man renounces completely all the desires of the mind, and when he is fully satisfied with his mind fixed in Atma, then he is declared to be a man of steady wisdom.

VERSE 2.56

दुःखेष्वनुद्विग्नमनाः सुखेषु विगतस्पृहः ।
वीतरागभयक्रोधः स्थितधीर्मुनिरुच्यते ॥ 56 ॥

duḥkheṣvanudvignamanāḥ
sukheṣu vigataspr̥haḥ |
vītarāgabhayakrodhaḥ
sthitadhīrmunirucyate ||

- ◆ **duḥkheṣu** – in sorrows; **anudvignamanāḥ** – unperturbed mind;
- ◆ **sukheṣu** – in pleasures; **vigata-spr̥haḥ** – free from longing;
- ◆ **vīta** – free from; **rāga** – attachment; **bhaya** – fear; **krodhaḥ** – anger;
- ◆ **sthitadhīḥ** – of steady wisdom; **munīḥ** – a sage; **ucyate** – is called.

He whose mind is not troubled in sorrow, who does not hanker after pleasures and is free from attachment fear and hatred, is called the sage of steady wisdom.

021. Chapter 2 Verses 56-57

VERSE 2.56

दुःखेष्वनुद्विग्नमनाः सुखेषु विगतस्पृहः ।
वीतरागभयक्रोधः स्थितधीर्मुनिरुच्यते ॥ 56 ॥

duḥkheṣvanudvignamanāḥ
sukheṣu vigataspr̥haḥ |
vītarāgabhayakrodhaḥ
sthitadhīrmunirucyate ||

duḥkheṣu – in sorrows; **anudvignamanāḥ** – unperturbed mind;
sukheṣu – in pleasures; **vigata-spr̥haḥ** – free from longing;
vīta – free from; **rāga** – attachment; **bhaya** – fear; **krodhaḥ** – anger;
sthitadhīḥ – of steady wisdom; **muniḥ** – a sage; **ucyate** – is called.

He whose mind is not troubled in sorrow, who does not hanker after pleasures and is free from attachment fear and hatred, is called the sage of steady wisdom.

VERSE 2.57

यः सर्वत्रानभिस्नेहस्तत्तत्प्राप्य शुभाशुभम् ।
नाभिनन्दति न द्वेष्टि तस्य प्रज्ञा प्रतिष्ठिता ॥ 57 ॥

yaḥ sarvatrānabhisnehas
tattatprāpya śubhāśubham |
nābhinandati na dveṣṭi
tasya prajñā pratiṣṭhitā ||

- ◆ **yaḥ** – who; **sarvatra** – everywhere; **anabhisnehaḥ** – without attachment;
- ◆ **tat tat** – whatever; **prāpya** – obtaining; **śubha-aśubham** – good or evil;
- ◆ **na** – not; **abhinandati** – rejoices; **na** – not; **dveṣṭi** – hates;
- ◆ **tasya** – his; **prajñā** – wisdom; **pratiṣṭhitā** – is established.

He who has no attachment to anything anywhere, who does not rejoice and hate when good and bad things happen, his wisdom is fixed and steady.

022. Chapter 2 Verses 58

VERSE 2.58

यदा संहरते चायं कूर्मोऽङ्गानीव सर्वशः ।
इन्द्रियाणीन्द्रियार्थेभ्यस्तस्य प्रज्ञा प्रतिष्ठिता ॥ 58 ॥

yadā saṁharate cāyaṁ
kūrmo'ṅgānīva sarvaśaḥ |
indriyāṇīndriyārthebhyas
tasya prajñā pratiṣṭhitā ||

- ◆ **yadā** – when; **saṁharate** – withdraws; **ca** – and; **ayam** – this (person);
- ◆ **kūrmaḥ** – tortoise; **aṅgāni** – limbs; **iva** – like; **sarvaśaḥ** – completely;
- ◆ **indriyāṇi** – the senses; **indriya-arthebhyaḥ** – from the objects of the senses;
- ◆ **tasya** – his; **prajñā** – wisdom; **pratiṣṭhitā** – is established.

When the yogi, like the tortoise drawing back its limbs into its own shell, withdraws all the senses from the sense objects, his wisdom is firmly fixed.

023. Chapter 2 Verses 59-63

VERSE 2.59

विषया विनिवर्तन्ते निराहारस्य देहिनः ।
रसवर्जं रसोऽप्यस्य परं दृष्ट्वा निवर्तते ॥ 59 ॥

viṣayā vinivartante
nirāhārasya dehinaḥ |
rasavarjaṁ raso'pyasya
paraṁ dr̥ṣṭvā nivartate ||

viṣayāḥ – objects of the senses; **vinivartante** – turn away;
nirāhārasya – for the abstinent; **dehinaḥ** – for the embodied;
rasa-varjaṁ – except the relish (taste); **rasaḥ** – relish; **api** – even; **asya** – his;
param – the Supreme; **dr̥ṣṭvā** – having seen; **nivartate** – turns away.

When a man rejects the sense objects by withdrawing the senses, he becomes free from the sense world only. The longing or taste for them still remains in the mind. Even this longing is removed when the self is perceived.

VERSE 2.60

यततो ह्यपि कौन्तेय पुरुषस्य विपश्चितः ।
इन्द्रियाणि प्रमाथीनि हरन्ति प्रसभं मनः ॥ 60 ॥

yatato hyapi kaunteya
puruṣasya vipaścitaḥ |
indriyāṇi pramāthīni
haranti prasabhaṁ manaḥ ||

yatataḥ – striving; **hi** – indeed; **api** – even; **kaunteya** – O son of Kunti;
puruṣasya – of a man; **vipaścitaḥ** – wise;
indriyāṇi – the senses; **pramāthīni** – turbulent;
haranti – carry away; **prasabham** – by force; **manaḥ** – the mind.

O Arjuna! The turbulent senses carry away the mind even of the learned man though he is striving to control them.

VERSE 2.61

तानि सर्वाणि संयम्य युक्त आसीत मत्परः ।
वशे हि यस्येन्द्रियाणि तस्य प्रज्ञा प्रतिष्ठिता ॥ 61 ॥

tāni sarvāṇi saṁyamya
yukta āsīta matparaḥ |
vaśe hi yasyendriyāṇi
tasya prajñā pratiṣṭhitā ||

tāni – them; **sarvān** – all; **saṁyamya** – having controlled;
yuktaḥ – steadfast; **āsīta** – should sit; **matparaḥ** – intent on Me;
vaśe – under control; **hi** – indeed; **yasya** – whose; **indriyāṇi** – senses;
tasya – his; **prajñā** – wisdom; **pratiṣṭhitā** – is established.

**Having restrained all the senses the harmonized should sit
intent on me. His wisdom is steady whose senses are under
control.**

As a man contemplates sense-objects, attachment for them arises, from attachment, desire for them will be born, from desire arises anger, ...

VERSE 2.63

क्रोधाद्भवति सम्मोहः सम्मोहात्स्मृतिविभ्रमः ।
स्मृतिभ्रंशाद् बुद्धिनाशो बुद्धिनाशात्प्रणश्यति ॥ 63 ॥

krodhādbhavati sammohaḥ
sammohātsmṛtīvibhramaḥ |
smṛtibhramaśād buddhināśo
buddhināśātpṛaṇaśyati ||

- ◆ **krodhāt** – from anger; **bhavati** – comes; **sammohaḥ** – delusion;
- ◆ **sammohāt** – from delusion; **smṛti-vibhramaḥ** – confusion of memory;
- ◆ **smṛti-bhramaśāt** – from loss of memory; **buddhi-nāśaḥ** – destruction of discrimination;
- ◆ **buddhi-nāśāt** – from destruction of discrimination; **pṛaṇaśyati** – he perishes.

... from anger comes delusion, from delusion, comes loss of memory, from loss of memory, comes destruction of discrimination, and from destruction of discrimination he perishes.

024. Chapter 2 Verses 64-66

VERSE 2.64

रागद्वेषवियुक्तैस्तु विषयानिन्द्रियैश्चरन् ।
आत्मवश्यैर्विधेयात्मा प्रसादमधिगच्छति ॥ 64 ॥

rāgadveṣaviyuktaistu
viṣayānindriyaiścaran |
ātmavaśyairvidheyātmā
prasādamadhigacchati ||

rāga-dveṣa-viyuktaiḥ – free from attraction and aversion; **tu** – but;
viṣayān – sense-objects; **indriyaiḥ** – by the senses; **caran** – moving among;
ātma-vaśyaiḥ – under self-control; **vidheya-ātmā** – the self-controlled man;
prasādam – serenity/peace; **adhigacchati** – attains.

But the self-controlled man free from attraction and repulsion, with his senses under restraint though moving among objects, attains peace.

VERSE 2.65

प्रसादे सर्वदुःखानां हानिरस्योपजायते ।
प्रसन्नचेतसो ह्याशु बुद्धिः पर्यवतिष्ठते ॥ 65 ॥

prasāde sarvaduḥkhānām
hānirasyopajāyate |
prasannacetaso hyāśu
buddhiḥ paryavatiṣṭhate ||

prasāde – in serenity; **sarva-duḥkhānām** – of all sorrows;
hāniḥ – destruction; **asya** – his; **upajāyate** – occurs;
prasanna-cetasaḥ – of the happy-minded; **hi** – indeed; **āśu** – quickly;
buddhiḥ – intellect; **pari-avatiṣṭhate** – becomes steady.

When a man attains peace, all sorrow and suffering caused by the unbalanced mind and rebellious senses come to an end. By peace and purity, the mind is soon fixed in the Self.

VERSE 2.66

नास्ति बुद्धिरयुक्तस्य न चायुक्तस्य भावना ।
न चाभावयतः शान्तिरशान्तस्य कुतः सुखम् ॥ 66 ॥

nāsti buddhirayuktasya
na cāyuktasya bhāvanā |
na cābhāvayataḥ śāntir
aśāntasya kutaḥ sukham ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **asti** – is; **buddhiḥ** – intellect/wisdom; **ayuktasya** – for the unsteady;
- ◆ **na** – not; **ca** – and; **ayuktasya** – for the unsteady; **bhāvanā** – meditation;
- ◆ **na** – not; **ca** – and; **abhāvayataḥ** – for the unmeditative; **śāntiḥ** – peace;
- ◆ **śāntasya** – for the peaceless; **kutaḥ** – where; **sukham** – happiness.

The man whose mind is not under his control has no Self-knowledge and no contemplation either. Without contemplation he can have no peace; and without peace, how can he have happiness?

025. Chapter 2 Verses 67-69

VERSE 2.67

इन्द्रियाणां हि चरतां यन्मनोऽनुविधीयते ।
तदस्य हरति प्रज्ञां वायुर्नावमिवाम्भसि ॥ 67 ॥

indriyāṇām hi caratām
yanmano'nuvidhīyate |
tadasya harati prajñām
vāyurnāvamivāmbhasi ||

- ◆ **indriyāṇām** – of the senses; **hi** – indeed; **caratām** – wandering;
- ◆ **yat** – which; **manaḥ** – the mind; **anuvidhīyate** – follows;
- ◆ **tat** – that; **asya** – his; **harati** – carries away; **prajñām** – wisdom;
- ◆ **vāyuḥ** – wind; **nāvam** – boat; **iva** – like; **ambhasi** – on the water.

As a strong wind sweeps away a boat on the water, even one of the senses on which the mind focuses can carry away the discrimination.

VERSE 2.68

तस्माद्यस्य महाबाहो निगृहीतानि सर्वशः ।
इन्द्रियाणीन्द्रियार्थेभ्यस्तस्य प्रज्ञा प्रतिष्ठिता ॥ 68 ॥

tasmādyasya mahābāho
nigṛhītāni sarvaśaḥ |
indriyāṇīndriyārthebhyas
tasya prajñā pratiṣṭhitā ||

- ◆ **tasmāt** – therefore; **yasya** – whose; **mahābāho** – O mighty-armed;
- ◆ **nigṛhītāni** – restrained; **sarvaśaḥ** – completely;
- ◆ **indriyāṇi** – senses; **indriya-arthebhyaḥ** – from sense-objects;
- ◆ **tasya** – his; **prajñā** – wisdom; **pratiṣṭhitā** – is established.

Therefore, O Arjuna! his knowledge is steady whose senses are completely restrained from all sense objects.

VERSE 2.69

या निशा सर्वभूतानां तस्यां जागर्ति संयमी ।
यस्यां जाग्रति भूतानि सा निशा पश्यतो मुनेः ॥ 69 ॥

yā niśā sarvabhūtānām
tasyām jāgarti saṁyamī |
yasyām jāgrati bhūtāni
sā niśā paśyato muneḥ ||

- ◆ yā – what; niśā – night; sarva-bhūtānām – of all beings;
- ◆ tasyām – in that; jāgarti – is awake; saṁyamī – the self-controlled;
- ◆ yasyām – in which; jāgrati – are awake; bhūtāni – beings;
- ◆ sā – that; niśā – night; paśyataḥ – for the seeing; muneḥ – for the sage.

**That which is, night to all beings, in it the sage is awake;
where all beings are awake, that is the night for the sage who
sees (the Self).**

026. Chapter 2 Verses 70-72

VERSE 2.70

आपूर्यमाणमचलप्रतिष्ठं
समुद्रमापः प्रविशन्ति यद्वत् ।
तद्वत्कामा यं प्रविशन्ति सर्वे
स शान्तिमाप्नोति न कामकामी ॥ 70 ॥

āpūryamāṇamacalapraṭiṣṭhaṁ
samudramāpaḥ praviśanti yadvat |
tadvatkāmā yaṁ praviśanti sarve
sa śāntimāpnoti na kāmakāmī ||

- ◆ āpūryamāṇam – being filled; **acala-pratiṣṭham** – based in stillness;
- ◆ **samudram** – ocean; **āpaḥ** – waters; **praviśanti** – enter; **yadvat** – as;
- ◆ **tadvat** – so; **kāmāḥ** – desires; **yaṁ** – whom; **praviśanti** – enter; **sarve** – all;
- ◆ **saḥ** – he; **śāntim** – peace; **āpnoti** – attains; **na** – not; **kāma-kāmī** – the desirer of desires.

As the ocean is filled with water flowing into it from all sides and remains immovable, so the man into whom all desires flow, but is not a bit affected attains peace and not the man who craves the desires.

VERSE 2.71

विहाय कामान्यः सर्वान्पुमांश्चरति निःस्पृहः ।
निर्ममो निरहङ्कारः स शान्तिमधिगच्छति ॥ 71 ॥

vihāya kāmānyaḥ sarvān
pumāṃścarati niḥspṛhaḥ |
nirmamo nirahaṅkāraḥ
sa śāntimidhigacchati ||

- ◆ **vihāya** – abandoning; **kāmān** – desires; **yaḥ** – who; **sarvān** – all;
- ◆ **pumān** – a man; **carati** – moves/lives; **niḥspṛhaḥ** – free from longing;
- ◆ **nirmamaḥ** – without 'mine-ness'; **nirahaṅkāraḥ** – without ego;
- ◆ **saḥ** – he; **śāntim** – peace; **adhigacchati** – attains.

That man who lives completely free from desires, without longing, devoid of the sense of “I” and “mine,” attains peace.

एषा ब्राह्मी स्थितिः पार्थ नैनां प्राप्य विमुह्यति ।
स्थित्वास्यामन्तकालेऽपि ब्रह्मनिर्वाणमृच्छति ॥ 72 ॥

eṣā brāhmī sthitiḥ pārtha
naināṃ prāpya vimuhyati |
sthitvāsyāmantakāle'pi
brahmanirvāṇamṛcchati ||

- ◆ eṣā – this; brāhmī – of Brahman; sthitiḥ – state; pārtha – O Partha;
- ◆ na – not; enām – this; prāpya – having attained; vimuhyati – is deluded;
- ◆ sthitvā – being established; asyām – in this; anta-kāle – at the end time (death); api – even;
- ◆ brahma-nirvāṇam – the bliss of Brahman; ṛcchati – attains.

Having obtained this Brahmi state man is not deluded. Being established in this even at the end of life man attains oneness with Brahman (Moksha).